From a Feeling to a Written List: The Family's Steps for Reviewing Dad's Care

Nine actions, in order, with a line for who does each and by when.

The goal: a written list of what Dad needs, who covers each part, what you've confirmed and what's still open, with a family member's name beside every open line.

Share the work. Put a name and a day next to each action, and tick it when it's done.

ACTION	WHO	BY WHEN	DONE
1. Gather the care plan, the agency's schedule and any assessment or summary you were given, with their dates.			
2. List what Dad needs help with, one need to a line, from the paperwork, from what you've seen and from what he tells you.			
3. Next to each need, write who covers it now: the agency, a family member, Dad himself, or no one yet.			
4. Mark each line “seen” or “told.” Seen means someone in the family watched it happen. Told means you're going on the paperwork or on what someone said.			
5. Ask your sister, or whoever fills in, to go through a usual week. Add what she does to the list, and write down how she says she's managing.			
6. Add the parts of Dad's week that aren't tasks: company, getting out, the things he enjoys, and how news travels between the people who help him.			
7. Note any need with no name beside it, and any place where two accounts differ. Write each as a plain line, with both versions where there are two.			
8. Set aside anything about his health or his medications as a question for his doctor or nurse. Change nothing.			
9. Next to each open line, write who in the family will ask about it, and who they'll ask.			

You're done when

Every need on the list says where it came from and who covers it, every line is marked seen, told or not sure yet, and each open line has a family member's name and a person to ask beside it. What comes after that, reading the list alongside a professional's own observations and deciding what any of it means for Dad's care, isn't on this plan, because it isn't the family's to do alone.

If a line won't fill in

- Don't fill it by guessing. “Not sure yet” is a finished line.
- If nobody has called back, the line stays “not sure yet.” It doesn't become “not happening.”
- If something about Dad's health worries you in the meantime, take it to his doctor or nurse directly. It doesn't need to go through this list first.

What this plan doesn't do

It organizes the family's part. It doesn't certify that Dad is safe, say whether his care is working, or decide whether anything should change. It works alongside his care plan and the people who provide his care, and doesn't replace either.

Ready for the next step?

You've turned a feeling into a written list, with a name beside each open line. The care interview goes through Dad's situation area by area with you, so the list rests on a complete picture, and turns your answers into a Family Care Profile you can bring to any care conversation.

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